
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Early Age Niefelheim

Sons of Winter

Progress Edition 31

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Unmodded 6.37 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Early Age Niefelheim: Sons of Winter

Early Age Niefelheim one-page command brief

Early Age Niefelheim converts frost giants, Jotun infantry, skinshifters, and Water-Death-Blood magic under a cold dominion into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 7 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are extreme gold costs, low model count, temperature, blood hunting, and replacing giants after attritional battles.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

Early Age Niefelheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Niefelheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 33, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Niefelheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

Early Age Niefelheim conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

Early Age Niefelheim recruitment geography

Recruitment layer	Commanders	Troops	Evidence boundary
Ordinary forts	6	8	Direct pinned membership rows
Regional or coastal	0	0	Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent
Site-linked	1	1	Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

Early Age Niefelheim commander roster

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
786	Jotun Scout	none	0
1301	Jotun Herse	none	75
1299	Jotun Jarl	H1	100
1300	Jotun Gode	H2	50
553	Jotun Skratti	W2 B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1	10
785	Gygja	D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x2 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1	50
844	Niefel Jarl	W3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1; 10% x1 mask 20992 link 1	150

Early Age Niefelheim troop roster

ID	Unit	HP	Protection	Morale	Traits
1302	Jotun Bondi	31	5	11	ordinary body
1303	Jotun Warrior	33	5	12	ordinary body
1304	Jotun Warrior	35	5	12	ordinary body
1305	Jotun Hurler	33	5	12	ordinary body
1306	Jotun Huskarl	35	5	13	ordinary body
1307	Godihuskarl	36	5	13	ordinary body
1308	Jotun Hirdman	38	5	13	ordinary body
845	Niefel Giant	69	7	14	sacred

Early Age Niefelheim mage and priest portfolio

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
1299	Jotun Jarl	H1	100
1300	Jotun Gode	H2	50
553	Jotun Skratti	W2 B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1	10
785	Gygja	D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x2 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1	50
844	Niefel Jarl	W3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1; 10% x1 mask 20992 link 1	150

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Death 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

Early Age Niefelheim capital and national sites

ID	Site	Monthly fields	Recruits recorded
46	Niefelheim	W4, D2	Niefel Jarl, Niefel Giant

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

Early Age Niefelheim national spell map

ID	Spell	School	Requirement	Cost field
491	Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions	Conjuration 8	A4 E3	62
494	Seith Curse	Thaumaturgy 5	D1 S1	3
496	Brood of Garm	Conjuration 4	N2	10
497	Awaken Jotun Draugar	Conjuration 4	D2	15
498	Summon Rimvaettir	Conjuration 5	W2	5
500	Illwinter	Blood 6	B5 W3	120

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

Early Age Niefelheim national item boundary

ID	Item	Construction	Paths	Link
114	The Sword of Aurgelmer	9	G6	rebate

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

Early Age Niefelheim hero boundary

ID	Hero record	Magic	Boundary
1382	Abductor	A3 W3 D3 H2	assignment only; timing unresolved
586	Great Hag	S3 D3 N2 G3 B3	assignment only; timing unresolved

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

Early Age Niefelheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Niefel Giant.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.

- Core identity: frost giants, Jotun infantry, skinshifters, and Water-Death-Blood magic under a cold dominion.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

Early Age Niefelheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

Early Age Niefelheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Niefelheim, the most likely planning failure is extreme gold costs, low model count, temperature, blood hunting, and replacing giants after attritional battles. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

Early Age Niefelheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

Early Age Niefelheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Death 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

Early Age Niefelheim battlefield packages

Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

Early Age Niefelheim Pretender families

Family	What it can solve	What it cannot conceal
Missing-path bridge	Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold	Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required
Economy and infrastructure	Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements	Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points
Sacred support	Improves a verified sacred package	Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain
Awake expansion body	Reduces pressure on the starting roster	Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents
Resistance package	Covers a documented roster weakness	One resistance is not universal defence

Early Age Niefelheim matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light units	Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves	Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage
Heavy armour	Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs	Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided
Accurate missiles	Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption	Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards
Elemental resistance	Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure	Building the complete research plan around one element
Fast raiders or flyers	Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves	Concentrating every commander in one army

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Large targets	Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters	Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal
Underwater or land transition	Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies	Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross

Early Age Niefelheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

Early Age Niefelheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

Early Age Niefelheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: all 37 unmodded Middle Age nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; communions, Chorus, and Grand Communion; Blood and crossbreeding; Inquisition; mounts; sailing; flying; forging; habitat transitions; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.37, including the current Send Aatxe restriction, communion corrections, the 6.13 Forest of Avalon Magic correction, the 6.01 Abysia wall-defender note, Eriu's 6.01 terrain-recruit and Bean Sidhe corrections, Agartha's 6.04 Oracle-shape note, and 6.37's bounded research, drowning, and Drake corrections. Generic statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed nation objects.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, conscription output, variable summon quantities, retinue and shape behaviour, flying and storm resolution, ice-equipment scaling, Guardian Spirit behaviour, remote ritual outcomes, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.